

Ingredients (1 kg Mutton)

Mutton

- 1 kg goat mutton (bone-in shoulder/leg pieces)

Fat

- 4 tbsp ghee (60 g)
- 2 tbsp mustard oil (30 ml)

Dairy

- 300 g thick curd (1¼ cup)

Aromatics

- 2 medium onions (200 g), thinly sliced
- 1 tbsp ginger paste (15 g)
- 1 tbsp garlic paste (15 g)

Whole Spices

- 2 bay leaves
- 1 black cardamom
- 4 green cardamoms
- 5 cloves
- 1-inch cinnamon stick
- 1 star anise (optional but excellent)

Ground Spices

- 2 tbsp Kashmiri chili powder
- 1 tsp regular red chili powder
- 2 tsp fennel powder
- 1 tsp dry ginger powder
- 1 tsp coriander powder
- ½ tsp turmeric
- 1½ tsp salt (adjust later)

Premium Additions

- 10–12 saffron strands
- 2 tbsp warm milk
- 1 tsp honey

Liquid

- 600–700 ml hot water
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Preparation

Step 1: Marinate (2–4 Hours)

Mix:

- 1 kg mutton
- 250 g curd
- 1 tbsp ginger paste
- 1 tbsp garlic paste
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp Kashmiri chili powder

Coat thoroughly.

Refrigerate for at least 2 hours, ideally 4 hours.

Cooking

Step 2: Prepare Saffron

Soak:

- 10–12 saffron strands
- 2 tbsp warm milk

Keep aside.

Step 3: Brown the Onions

1. Heat:
 - 4 tbsp ghee
 - 2 tbsp mustard oil
2. Add sliced onions.
3. Cook on medium heat for 15–20 minutes until deep golden brown.

Do not burn them.

Step 4: Add Whole Spices

Add:

- 2 bay leaves
- 1 black cardamom
- 4 green cardamoms
- 5 cloves
- 1-inch cinnamon
- 1 star anise

Cook for 1 minute.

Step 5: Sear the Mutton

Add the marinated mutton.

Cook on high heat for 10–12 minutes.

Keep stirring.

The meat should lose its raw color and begin browning.

Step 6: Add Spice Mix

Add:

- 1 tbsp Kashmiri chili powder
- 1 tsp regular chili powder
- 2 tsp fennel powder
- 1 tsp dry ginger powder
- 1 tsp coriander powder
- ½ tsp turmeric

Cook for 3–4 minutes.

Step 7: Slow Cooking

Add:

- 600–700 ml hot water

Bring to a gentle boil.

Cover tightly.

Cook on the lowest heat for:

- 2½–3 hours in a pot

OR

- Pressure cook for 6 whistles and then simmer uncovered for 20 minutes.

The meat should become extremely tender.

Step 8: Luxury Finish

Add:

- Saffron milk
- 50 ml cream
- 1 tsp honey

Simmer for 10 minutes.

Taste and adjust salt.

Step 9: Final Touch

Turn off the heat.

Add:

- 1 tbsp ghee

Cover and rest for 15 minutes.

This final resting step makes a noticeable difference.

Serve With

- Long-grain basmati rice
- Butter naan

- Garlic naan

For a complete meal:

- Onion rings
- Lemon wedges
- Mint raita

Result

- Rich, deep red gravy
- Extremely tender mutton
- Balanced spice, sweetness, and aroma
- Suitable for 4–5 people

For even more flavor, cook it in a heavy Dutch oven or cast-iron pot over very low heat for the full 3 hours instead of using a pressure cooker. That produces the deepest flavor and best texture.